

‘Security OF the Cloud’ – this refers to the responsibility of AWS in providing cloud services for its customers.

‘Security IN the Cloud’ – this refers to the responsibility of the customers in using the cloud services provisioned by AWS.

AWS Responsibility	Customer Responsibility	Shared Responsibility
Physical server hardware	EC2 operating system patches	Patch Management
Data centre cooling & power	S3 bucket access policy	Configuration Management
Network firewall between AZs	IAM user passwords & MFA	Security Awareness Training
Hypervisor (virtualisation layer)	Encrypting data stored in S3	
Database backups on RDS (managed)	Who can access your AWS account	
	SSL certificate on your web app	
	Database backups — MySQL running on EC2	

AWS Shared Responsibility Model — My Summary

- David Adeleke (22/04/2026)

AWS Responsibility	Shared Controls	Customer Responsibility
Physical server hardware	Patch Management	EC2 operating system patches
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Without looking at notes, open a new Word document and write 3 sentences explaining the Shared Responsibility Model to a non-technical business owner.

Target audience: A Lagos restaurant owner who is considering moving their POS system and customer data to the cloud.

Tip: Pretend you are explaining it to your parent or a friend who has never heard the word 'cloud' used in a tech context. Plain language only.

This is a brilliant consideration, what AWS would be doing for you and essentially managing for you includes the physical computers/servers, the networking, power, and cooling of the physical infrastructure, and 24/7 availability. This allows you to manage and focus better on your application, the operating system configurations, patches, and access management. This matters a lot because a lot of businesses like yourself might not be able to afford the huge Capital Expenditure that comes with on-prem (i.e. purchasing and managing the servers/computers and other physical infrastructure need), especially as you expand, and redundancy would even cost more, as you wouldn't want just one single point of failure, in case there is data loss due to disaster or some other incident.